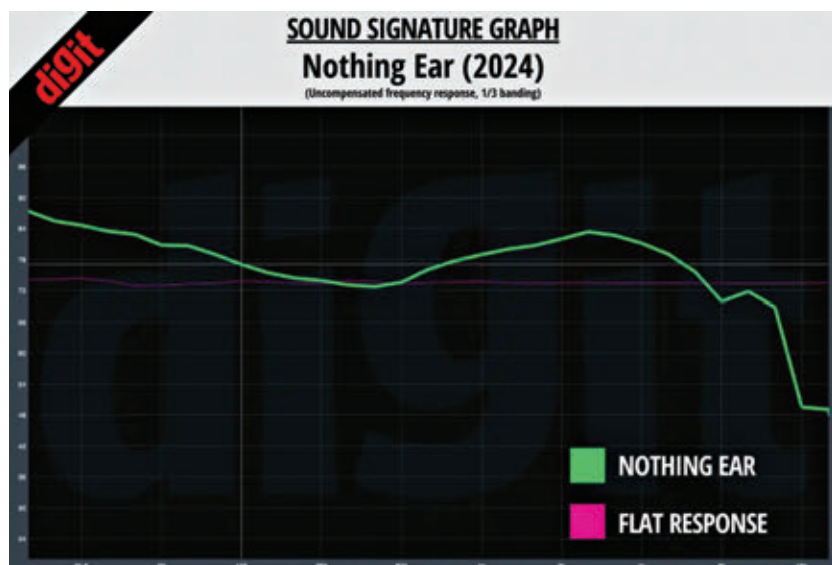




earbuds can interact with ChatGPT via voice. I tried this out by connecting the Nothing Ear to the Nothing Phone (2) and the experience of using ChatGPT was very smooth. It's quite useful; for instance, I asked ChatGPT to narrate recipes I could follow along while in the kitchen, and it worked seamlessly.

PERFORMANCE

The Nothing Ear (2024) features 11 mm ceramic drivers with support for 24-bit Hi-Res Audio with LDAC and LHDC high-quality codec support. The earphones also support the SBC and AAC codecs. The new ceramic diaphragm is engineered to deliver more clarity and sound accuracy, according to Nothing.

The sound quality on the new Nothing Ear (2024) is quite refined. The sound is slightly bass-biased, but it doesn't sound muddy or boomy out of the box. Furthermore, a few tweaks to the equalizer in the app can lower the bass if you want a more neutral sound profile. For general users, especially the Indian audience that enjoys boosted bass, the earphones' sound signature is near perfect.

There's plenty of thump and gravitas in the low end while ensuring the mids are pristine and the highs have a good sparkle. Additionally, the soundstage is one of the widest in this price category, giving plenty of room for instruments to

breathe. Instrument separation is also great; there's minimal overlapping. With the LDAC codec active, the Nothing Ear gives tough competition to the OPPO Enco X2, which is currently one of the most neutral-sounding pairs of TWS earphones at this price range.

In our frequency graph test, we see that the Nothing Ear has a boost in the bass region from 20 Hz to 125 Hz, which gives it a warm sound profile. The highs are boosted around the 2.5-3 kHz mark to achieve a pleasant V-shaped sound signature. Overall, the sound signature of the Nothing Ear is pleasant and will appeal to most users. There are very low levels of distortion even at high volumes, making this an excellent option for music lovers.

As for call quality, the Nothing Ear houses three microphones per earbud assisted by Nothing's Clear Voice Technology, which isolates your voice from ambient noise to ensure clear phone calls. The earbuds are fantastic for taking calls both indoors and outdoors. I was able to converse on the phone even in a crowded Mumbai local, which is known for being quite chaotic.

BATTERY LIFE

The Nothing Ear (2024)'s battery life shows some improvement over its predecessor, but it is still not close to the top dogs in this category. The

Nothing Ear lasted us only 3 hours and 26 minutes with the LDAC codec and ANC active. In contrast, the OnePlus Buds Pro 2 are more long-lasting, with the buds alone lasting over 5 hours on a single charge with ANC active. With the charging case, the Nothing Ear gave us a total playtime of 18.5 hours, not the best showing in the space.

However, the earbuds do have fast charging support. So, a quick 10-minute charge will get you about 10 hours of playtime, which is pretty good. The earphones also support Qi wireless charging, so if you have the Nothing Phone (2), you can use reverse wireless charging to top these buds up.

VERDICT

The Nothing Ear (2024) are an extraordinary pair of TWS earphones. Despite the mediocre ANC and battery life, these earbuds deliver a true flagship TWS experience. The sound quality and features more than justify their price, especially with industry-first features like ChatGPT integration with Nothing phones. The Nothing Ear (2024) marks the first step in Nothing's grand plan to create a cohesive ecosystem of products that complement its smartphones. However, even if you don't own a Nothing smartphone, nearly all features are accessible through the Nothing X app on other smartphones. If battery life is your primary concern, the OnePlus Buds Pro 2 might be a better option. For everything else, the Nothing Ear (2024) is one of the most well-rounded TWS earbuds available under ₹12,000.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Driver: 11 mm dynamic driver | Diaphragm material: Ceramic | Playback (ANC off): 8.5 hours (buds), 40.5 hours (with case) | Playback (ANC on): 5.2 hours (buds), 24 hours (with case) | Fast charging: Yes, 10 minutes for 10 hours | Battery capacity: 46 mAh (buds), 500 mAh (case) | ANC: Up to 45 dB | Bluetooth version: 5.3 | Codecs: AAC, SBC, LDAC, LHDC | IP rating: IP54 (buds), IP55 (case) | App: Nothing X

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